

SKYROOT (SPACETECH)

- **PAWAN KUMAR CHANDANA**, CO-FOUNDER & CEO
- **NAGA BHARATH DAKA**, CO-FOUNDER

- > **KEY INVESTORS** GIC, Temasek, Greenko Founders, Mukesh Bansal, Ram Shriram
- > **FUNDING** It has raised \$95 million through five fundraising rounds
- > **WHAT MAKES IT COOL** It is building rockets that would open up space for all

► **IN 2018**, Pawan Kumar Chandana and Naga Bharath Daka, former Isro scientists, embarked on a bold odyssey into the unexplored realms of the space sector, laying the foundation for Skyroot. Back then, India had no private space action. But the duo sensed something in the air—a vibe that the government might be eyeing a private space chapter. Seeing the rapid expansion of the global space sector, coupled with India's potential to address the lifestyle needs of its vast population through spacetechnology, it felt like the right move.

Then in 2020, when India opened up its space sector, Skyroot rode the wave hard. In 2022, it fired up India's first private launch vehicle, the Vikram-S. The company is now prepping for its second

mission: Vikram-I—a commercial orbital rocket, and a first for India and South Asia, in H12O24.

With academic expertise spanning mechanical engineering, thermal science, electrical engineering, and microelectronics, the founders' diverse backgrounds are a strategic asset.

"Over the next decade, we expect more than 30,000 satellites to be launched globally, most of them being small satellites weighing under 500 kg, and aspire to be a key player within this," the founders say. The company, currently focused on infrastructure investments, incurred losses of ₹55.24 crore in FY23, alongside a modest operating revenue of ₹44 lakh. **BT**

— **BY BINU PAUL**

**SPRINTO (CLOUD SECURITY)**

- **GIRISH REDEKAR**, CO-FOUNDER & CEO
- **RAGHUVVEER KANCHERLA**, CO-FOUNDER

- > **KEY INVESTORS** Accel Partners, Blume and Elevation Capital
- > **FUNDING** It raised \$11.5 million in 2022

► **After cutting his teeth in US-based companies for half a decade, Girish Redekar, an IIT Madras alumnus, co-founded Recruiterbox in 2010, specialising in B2B SaaS. However, during this journey, they hit a roadblock of security challenges, prompting them to bring in a compliance consultant, that turned out to be time-consuming and costly. In 2020, he exited Recruiterbox. After taking a year off, he set his eyes on security compliance for cloud-based tech companies, carving out a niche by exclusively catering to cloud-hosted entities. That's how Srinto was born. His partner was Raghuvveer Kancharla, his IIT mate who was also at Recruiterbox. As an automation platform for compliance, this start-up accelerates the certification process for information security management systems, data protection, safeguarding sensitive patient data, security, confidentiality, and privacy. In FY22, Srinto posted revenue of ₹3.2 crore and a loss of ₹10.8 crore, per Tracxn. **BT****

— **BY ANAND ADHIKARI**

